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Innovative Practice

Indigenous Knowledges in an Open Access Context

A Case Study on the Development of a Locally Situated Indigenous Syilx Okanagan Interior Salish Informed Land-based Academic Writing Guide

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Abstract

This article presents a case study of the processes involved and questions raised in the creation of a locally situated Indigenous university writing guide. This article discusses how the teaching of university writing might be Indigenized and what the implications might be for instructors and learners and for publishers of writing and pedagogy guides who wish to make their work accessible in open education environments. The Indigenous writing guide raises questions regarding the sharing of Indigenous knowledges (IK) within the open access and digital domain. Our main argument and practice throughout are that guidance and care are needed in navigating the nuanced and layered ethics for working with, citing, and sharing IK in open educational resources, in academia, and beyond. This article shares some of those considerations we encountered and attempts to initiate further discussion of these issues within academic writing and open education publishing contexts.

Keywords:

Indigenous Writing, Indigenous Knowledges and Writing Style, Open Education

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Introduction

Ey swayel dear ones. Welcome to this interstitial gathering space. We recognize and are conscious of the tə́məxʷ (downriver Coast Salish hən̓q̓əmin̓əm̓) and the physical and metaphysical Land we are a part of as we write this article. We write from the Land of the Syilx People in the Okanagan in the city of Kelowna. Syilx Okanagan People conceptualize "Land" as tmixʷ and tmxʷulaxʷ (Interior Salish nsyilxcn) (Armstrong, 2009). The authors of this chapter also write from other Lands and landscapes. One of us, who is Coast Salish, writes from a sense of tə́məxʷ (Archibald, 2008; Carlson et al. 2001; Miller, 2007; Suttles, 2004) and opens this chapter with the downriver Coast Salish hən̓q̓əmin̓əm̓-speaking Peoples' greeting that includes the relational endearment and includes the Coast Salish term for the lifeforce concept of Land that Salishan Peoples understand themselves to be a part of and which constitutes their reality.

We are about to do important work. In Coast Salish contexts, "work" refers to healing, medicine, governance, and other kinds of community and family work. The work of de- or anti-colonial Indigenizing of the academy is important work that includes shifting the imbalance of power relations in terms of governance and structures such as pedagogy, knowledge sharing, knowledge ethics, and protocols including citational practices and the ways in which we write and communicate in universities. From a Coast Salish Peoples' spiritual cultural perspective, this is also healing work (Pierre cited in Jenness, 1955).

Grounded in a recognition of how Indigenous knowledges (IK) and Land ethics are embedded in Indigenous languages, in movements to revitalize Indigenous languages, and in efforts to Indigenize curriculum (Archibald, 2008; Armstrong, 2009; Kirkness, 2013; Younging 2018), our project supports and elaborates on concerns that Indigenous communities have regarding IK shared in the public domain (Assembly of First Nations, 2011; First Nations Information Governance Centre, 2022; Lar-Son, 2021; McCracken and Hogan 2020; Smith 2012). In relation to our writing guide, these concerns cluster particularly around audience (Robinson, 2020), research ethics (Smith, 2012) and acknowledgement practices (Hergesheimer, 2016). The project we refer to throughout this article, explained in detail below, is the development of a first year writing guide specifically for Indigenous students founded on Syilx Peoples' knowledges and protocols.

Guiding questions as we build on the work of previous scholars in these areas and approach the development of this writing resource include: Where there is overlap of Indigenous and Western knowledge systems in this era of colonialism, how can one protect IK? What role does ownership have in working with IK in OER? What are the ways in which differing audiences, Indigenous, settler/non-Indigenous public and non-Indigenous allies can learn to interpret, understand and engage with IK when it is present? And how can that engagement be mediated in an open education resource (OER) context? What benefits might sharing IK in an OER avail Indigenous students?

The work of Indigenous scholars in critical Indigenous studies focuses on the importance of being aware of two audiences, Indigenous and non-Indigenous, when sharing knowledge (Armstrong, 2009; Coulthard, 2014; Robinson, 2020; Simpson, 2011). They work to protect IK that originate in and are meant for certain contexts and certain Indigenous audiences at certain

times. Further, these scholars encourage their Indigenous audiences to prioritize and direct their energies toward Indigenous land-based and traditional based scholarship and practices that focus on an embodied living of Indigenous governance and sovereignty (Corntassel and Hardbarger, 2019; Coulthard, 2014; Simpson, 2011; Tuck and Yang, 2012). This is often referred to as "resurgence" or "resurgent" practice (Corntassel and Hardbarger, 2019).

These scholars assert that the capacity for non-Indigenous peoples to understand and value IK in its context, purpose, and with sufficient depth is loaded with potential for harm. This is born out when one considers the colonial period, which we are still in, where IK has been misappropriated, mis/de-contextualized, greatly misunderstood, demonized, diminished, extracted, and "researched to death" while IK's true purposes, contexts, and the authority of their knowledge-holders have too often been and continue to be dismissed, ignored, unheard, and unfelt (Smith, 2012). Therefore, we believe that when thinking about working with IK and with IK keepers/holders/protectors, this knowledge can never be held in the same way by non-Indigenous Peoples.

We recognize terms such as IK and Traditional Knowledge are somewhat different (Younging, 2018). While there are elders, knowledge keepers, holders and protectors of specific kinds of IK, and given that we have heard Elders say that every Indigenous person holds "pieces" or strands of the knowledges that colonialism sought to break, we feel it is important to consider that every Indigenous Person holds and expresses IK (Grant, personal communication 2012; Oleman, personal communication, 2011). However, it is also important to understand that Indigenous People holding specific IK adhere to their particular Peoples' protocols regarding knowledge and take seriously their responsibilities to that knowledge and to family, community, elders and the Land (Archibald, 2008; Armstrong, 2009; Kirkness and Barnhardt, 2001). Thus, Indigenous Peoples should be asked permission for the inclusion of any type of their IK in any format before sharing it publicly and especially within an OER platform.

OER is a relatively new environment with an exponentially increased speed at which information can be accessed, copied, and repackaged, coupled with very emergent policy and little regulation. This situation heightens the risks of cultural appropriation that have proliferated since the onset of colonization and especially during the late 19th century to the later decades of the 20th century and heightens the possibility of further harm done to Indigenous People, their communities, and their legacies. In an OER context, we felt it necessary to deeply consider the purpose, context, audience, and time but also the responsibility, the relationship, and the accountability to the knowledge and to the IK holder who shared that knowledge, whether in person or within a given published text or digital document. It was important to consider whether that IK holder was an elder, community member, or knowledge keeper, as well as if that person were an Indigenous professor or Indigenous student. In this regard we looked to the work of Indigenous scholars working in the area of ethics and IK.

We looked at the principles of Indigenous storywork (Archibald, 2008), the principles of Indigenous education (Kirkness and Barnhardt, 2001), the principles of Indigenous style (Younging, 2018) and considered them in contrast to current principles of OER (Wiley, 2014). Further, we looked to Indigenous scholars who are currently doing cutting edge work in critically

addressing and articulating the nuanced and deeper level of colonial dynamics at work in the very ways we perceive with our senses. We specifically appreciated Dylan Robinson's (2020) call to decolonize perception, asking his readers to become aware of how their listening—what one hears and what one interprets and attaches values to what one hears—is colonized, and he recommends an approach of listening with a critical listening positionality. We felt this approach could be transposed over to the field of writing and to written work involving IK and to how an audience, writer, or reader approaches reading, interpreting, and writing. Further, we felt it valuable to imagine how a multimodal text might be understood and interpreted in an OER format through a decolonizing perceptual position and approach. Additionally, we felt that this critical listening, reading, and writing position would be all the more important given the risks involved in the OER digital realm and the heightened care required when including IK there.

We believe that decolonizing perception and approach go hand in hand with Indigenizing. We firmly believe that Indigenizing should not be conceived of as an add on of content. Rather, Indigenizing should be understood as a way of approaching and engaging with Indigenous Peoples' values, oral tradition, IK and Traditional Ecological Knowledge (TEK), and Indigenous Peoples' millennia-honed ethical framework and ways of perceiving the nature of reality. We wondered about the ways in which OER might support this understanding of Indigenizing.

When Indigenous Peoples' Relational Research Ethics Meets Western Capital's Extractive Research Ethics

Ethics of Perception and the Sharing of Indigenous Knowledges

In listening to Indigenous scholars, community members, and elders, we learned that when working with IK and Indigenous Knowledge Keepers (IKK), audience considerations must be often, if not always, different. We noticed that when working with IK and IKK, one is working with at least two different overlapping audiences. For example, one of us explained that when she writes in academic contexts, she writes with her Katzie Coast Salish grandmother, great-aunt, family, community, and ancestors past and future in mind, and her mind map vision is that of her ancestral Land or tə́məxʷ terrain that she understands to be both physical and metaphysical. She feels an accountability and a responsibility to them. She writes with three audiences in mind: her ancestral family and Land audience, her scholarly audience, and her Indigenous scholarly audience. This multiplicity of audiences has implications for purpose and context, and importantly, in terms of how the communicated message is heard, received, and understood.

Within a communication situation where there is an overlap of both the Indigenous Peoples' oral tradition and the Western tradition, there needs to be differing levels of preparedness corresponding to differing levels and kinds of understanding of IK. The oral tradition takes differing levels of preparedness for understanding into consideration when approaching the listening for the teachings, histories, and/or potential governance knowledge expressed through a given storytelling (Archibald, 2008; Basso, 1996; Cruikshank, 2005). This unique kind of preparedness is a concept that comes down through millennia-honed oral tradition

and is explained by Interior Salish, syilx Okanagan scholar Jeannette Armstrong and by Coast Salish upriver Sto:lo scholars such as Dylan Robinson and Jo-ann Archibald. The preparedness to hear knowledges in the oral tradition can also be applied to knowledges in interstitial spaces where IK occurs within colonial structures and institutions. OER could be said to be one of those structures and institutions. Therefore, it behooves those hoping to engage with and hear IK appropriately and in the way IK holders and producers wish them to be heard to learn what kind of preparedness needs to happen.

Infused with this idea of preparedness is the question of ownership. Ownership is perhaps not the best word for what Indigenous People generally think of when we think of IK, where they are held, and the ways in which they are expressed. This is why one does not hear very much about ownership among the works of Indigenous scholars or knowledge keepers; rather, what one does hear are the values, protocols, and concepts of responsibility, accountability, and care for IK (Archibald, 2008; Armstrong, 2009; Kirkness and Barnhardt, 2001; Robinson, 2020; Simpson, 2011). In the creation of our guide, these ideas of responsibility, accountability, and care were of most concern to us, and we constantly asked how the OER platform could protect, be responsive and responsible, and take care of the IK in our guide. We found that it was up to us to protect, be responsible for, and take care of the IK in our guide in the way we presented discussions of IK and to take care not to share sacred or private IK that belonged in community and family contexts rather than in university or OER contexts.

A benefit of OER is that, unlike solely print-based resources, if the authors realized that knowledge was inappropriately included, they can quickly be removed and address the error. With print, it can take years and large sums of funding to remove such an error, if at all. For example, there are several instances in the public domain of print from the early to late 20th century in which the extremely sacred Coast Salish mask was photographed and published. For example, on the Facebook account titled “Lost History” at the time of this writing, a photo was posted of the most sacred Coast Salish mask and IK, originating from and belonging to Musqueam People and Land; it is only brought out on the most sacred of private community ceremonies. These instances have yet to be remedied, and such publications have expanded into the public domain and could still be causing harmful spiritual and material effects to those involved.

We wanted to avoid the performative Indigenization that can happen when decolonization is not included, and we wanted to model this in our OER. We wanted to be story ready and listen beyond our colonially mediated ears, and we wanted to bring this to the OER. We felt it would be all the more possible with the multimodality that OER in a digital space affords. In “Writing Indigenous Space,” Dylan Robinson (2020) discusses the problematics associated with the situation of a Western performance that has been Indigenized. Robinson could be said to be teaching his readers how to become better prepared or to become what Stó:lō scholar Jo-ann Archibald (2008) refers to as “story ready.” As a Stó:lō positioned listener, Dylan Robinson presents the situation of a Western performance that has been Indigenized and the problematics associated with the fact that in the performance and context, the possible governance, medicine, historical, and teaching function of a given Indigenous music or song becomes reduced to a

Western function of entertainment with a Western audience in mind. Indigenous audiences and Indigenous Peoples' purposes, contexts, and resurgent structures for story are not taken into account.

Robinson pushes back against the settler colonial state's unmarked, dominant, and imposed forms of listening. He invites readers to consider "perceptual decolonization" (p. 42). We imagined the digital flexibility that OER offered might be able to take this into account and offer ways to decolonize perception. The consideration of purpose, context, audience, time, and relationship with IK, and the knowledge keeper who shared that knowledge, aligns with Indigenous Peoples' relational ethics regarding IK (Archibald, 2008; Armstrong, 2009; Battiste, 1995; Cohen, 2010; Robinson, 2020; Smith, 2012). This extends to Indigenous citation practices. We also drew on Dylan Robinson's work on listening positionality and critiques of inclusion and recognition that we see as having a connection to the situation that Indigenous students find themselves in when writing in the academy. Inclusion often is an add-on approach, and Robinson (2020) explains that "drawing on the critical literature of inclusion" (Ahmed, 2012; MacKey, 2002), Hungry Listening indicts those displays of equality that are more concerned with importing Indigenous content and increasing representation than with redefining the structures of inclusion" (p. 6). We hoped that OER could offer a way of redefining the structure of inclusion through its flexibility as discussed later in this article.

Robinson draws on Yellowknives Dene scholar Glen Coulthard's (2014) critique in Red Skin White Masks of when the Canadian state post-1969 white paper moved, as he states,

> …from a more-or-less unconcealed and coercive structure of domination to one that is now reproduced through a more conciliatory set of language and practices that emphasize the recognition and accommodation of Indigenous difference…in situations where colonial rule does not depend solely on the exercise of state violence, its reproduction instead rests on the ability to entice Indigenous people to identify, either explicitly or implicitly, with profoundly asymmetrical and nonreciprocal forms of recognition either imposed on or granted to them by the settler state and society. (p. 25)

This critique can also be applied to education contexts extending into OER. As school districts work to provide learning environments that are more culturally safe, and as more Indigenous students are graduating high school, Indigenous people are increasingly invited into university spaces; however, we see academic writing and ways of communicating in university as forms that make demands that require a certain kind of identifying that recall Coulthard's observation. In our context, that "recognition" is recognition as a university student in a form of the academy that has a long colonial history.

Hungry Listening examines "normative and unmarked forms of listening privilege within settler colonial listening positionality and the larger category of critical listening positionality" (Robinson, 2020, p. 10). Robinson (2020) explains further that "'settler colonial listening positionalities' can generally be understood as particular assemblages of unmarked structures of certainty that guide normative perception and may enact epistemic violence" (p. 10). We think a similar understanding could be applied to reading and writing; that is, there are listening or reading positionalities involved in terms of how one hears or reads a text impacting what one

focuses on and how one interprets the words in a given text. This also has implications for how one interprets and assesses a student's work on an essay assignment. In our writing guide, we wished to create space to reflect and raise consciousness regarding this dynamic so that Indigenous students have tools and sources they can cite to provide them with the authority to bring Indigenous structures into their academic work in an academy that we envision as being in a state of structural transformation through a decolonial indigenization (See the UBC Indigenous Strategic Plan).

In his section entitled "Writing redress," Robinson (2020) discusses how his "figuration of 'disciplinary redress' is a corrective not only to a non-Indigenous authority and its discursive control over narrating Indigenous history and cultural practice, but to the epistemic violence that takes place at the level of language and structure of writing itself" (p. 11). He further proposes that "disciplinary redress demands…non-Indigenous scholars amend their citational practice to prioritize...Indigenous methodologies and forms of writing and knowledge dissemination" (p. 11-12). We see our OER as offering a multiplicity of ways to enliven Indigenous methodologies, writing strategies, knowledges and citation practices. This includes digital flexibility, multimodality beyond text (i.e., video embeds, links to live sources, sound and speech embeds), ease of community accessibility to the OER via the online extra-institutional environment, multi-directional navigational logic, varying levels of access for varying levels of story preparedness and differing audiences, and password protection for the various levels of access.

Other scholars have also been calling for increased inclusion of Indigenous methodologies and voices in scholarly citations, and these concerns should also be included in OER. In 2012, Tuck and Yang urged scholars to question who they tend to cite, calling for a citation challenge. Daniel Heath Justice (2014) asserts a conscious choice to favorably include those who tend to be excluded from scholarly conversations in his book *Indigenous Literatures Matter*. Rooted in concepts of acknowledgement and ownership, citational practices are entwined with these same issues in OER. There has been a gap in the scholarship regarding changes that could happen in terms of the forms of writing that Robinson (2020) is initiating in *Hungry Listening*. He addresses his readers directly and asks his non-Indigenous readers to stop reading one section of the book that is reserved for Indigenous readers only. This move foregrounds discomfort and opportunity for non-Indigenous readers to be faced with not getting access to all of IK and importantly gives Indigenous readers freedom to speak and hear each other beyond the constant settler surveillance we are burdened with in the current colonial panoptican.

In light of critical work such as Robinson's (2020) which urges new critically aware perceptual positionalities as a way to prevent and address risks of engaging in cognitive imperialism, cultural appropriation, and related colonial harms and impacts, our work seeks to address this gap in imagining new ways to transform writing practices and forms of communicating knowledge in universities, and we see OERs'openness as potentially having room for new ways of writing and citing IK that includes new and old ways of structuring IK, particularly in the spaces where IK and Western knowledge meet.

Two Knowledge Systems and Their Citational Protocols and Practices Text

Indigenous knowledges are attached to Indigenous Peoples' relational ethics and expressed and manifested in Indigenous Peoples' forms of governance in ceremonies and in land-practices (Coulthard, 2014; Simpson, 2011). Indigenous Peoples' citation practices are attached to certain knowledges within ceremonial and land-practices that are forms of governance. We wanted our guide to enact the governance and sovereignty that Indigenous scholars, knowledge keepers, elders, community leaders, and students are calling for. A way to do this was to situate our guide in the contexts of a shared space that included both university and local Indigenous contexts and goals. Indigenous Peoples' citation practices are expressed in oral tradition formats such as speeches in longhouses, pit houses, tipis, on the land, in the auditorium, in the classroom, and increasingly in Indigenous scholarship (Archibald, 2008; Charnley, 2021; NorQuest College, 2019; Robinson, 2020; Simpson, 2011; Younging, 2018). We noticed that in their work, Indigenous scholars are finding ways to include these considerations of citational practice, differing audiences, differing purposes, and differing contexts associated with different audiences. They are doing so not only by discursive or argumentative means but also by inserting new ways of talking to and addressing their readers and imagining and implementing new ways of structuring the forms of their scholarly writing (Robinson, 2020).

These citation practices correspond with the imagining of new ways of doing scholarship when engaging with any IK wherever it is located. With this in mind, we learned that due to the ease and hyper speed with which information on the web can proliferate, it is imperative that we take the time, slow down the pace, so that caution, care and consideration can be taken when thinking about putting IK discussion in an OER. The benefits of OER, such as the speed and ease with which a student or instructor can access an on-line resource with minimal to no financial expense required, must be weighed with other kinds of costs: the concerns, cautions, and ethics considerations regarding the protection of IK and IKK and appreciating how the misappropriation and extractive relationship to IK and IKK in the past must be addressed and righted in the present and going forward.

Taking these concerns into an OER context, our Indigenous writing guide pursues and elaborates on questions regarding the sharing of IK, arguing that guidance and care must be developed to navigate the complexities of differing Western colonial capitalist and Indigenous community values and ethics.

Case Study of Our Process in Creating the Guide

The idea of writing indigenously in the academy is a relatively new one. It can be perceived as a new pathway that resides along interstitial trajectories of colonial "drives," Western intellectual tradition, decolonial moves and movements, and Indigenous Peoples' intellectual tradition. Indigenous Peoples' intellectual tradition includes the oral tradition and Traditional Ecological Knowledge. In Indigenous communities the local land, place, people, and ancestors are acknowledged, thanked, and cited (Charnley, 2019). Due to the work of Canadian Indigenous residential school survivors, the Truth and Reconciliation Commission, and calls for

action, Indigenous Peoples are being acknowledged and invited to welcome participants at civic, regional, provincial, and national as well as Indigenous conferences and gatherings.

From within the academy, calls have been issued for a place outside of the Western intellectual tradition to not only include previously marginalized communities but to innovate and transform its practices, structures, and the ways in which decision making is done. The academy now appears to be not one place but many places where a diversity of voices and a diversity of discourse communities exist. One may ask, is there an Indigenous Peoples' discourse community? If so, what have been its moves? Opaskwayak Cree scholar Shawn Wilson (2008) invites students to write with the "I" as a way to enact Indigenous Peoples' relational values and practices in writing. Xwélméxw Stó:lō/Skwah scholar Dylan Robinson (2020) asks his readers to position themselves as Indigenous or non-Indigenous and to beware and be aware of "hungry listening" and the consumer and extractive values attached to it.

Secwépemc artist, activist, and curator Tania Willard's scholarship through curation, art and installation work around the concept of site/ation (Willard and Morin, 2018), a term coined by Anishnaabe legal scholar John Borrows (2016), expands and Indigenizes citation, transforming what we think of as citation to land relationships and reminding us that all knowledge stems from the Land. Site/ation asks us to cite the Land as the first place of knowledge. The guide is also indebted to Opaskwayak Cree-Chinese Greg Younging's (2018) *Elements of Indigenous Style*, which provided one of the first published discussions of how to write Indigenously. Younging (2018) addresses culturally appropriate writing and publishing practices including respectful terminology, cultural recognition through capitalization, inappropriate possessives, problematic uses of past tense, and recognition of Indigenous colloquial English.

Following the work of these scholars, the need for the guide arose both from the question, "What does it mean to write indigenously in the academy?" and from the very practical realization that a comprehensive guide for new scholars, relating and rethinking writing and research practices in relation to Indigenous, specifically Syilx knowledges and methodologies and a guide for Indigenous students and Indigenous students' vision for their writing education, did not yet exist. While writing courses for Indigenous students are becoming more common at Canadian post-secondary institutions, and there are some admirable short guides (e.g., Four Directions Teachings, 2012; Royal Roads, 2022; Wilfred Laurier University, 2009), a detailed textbook is not yet available. We sought to fill that gap. Our guide is specifically geared to Indigenous students and secondarily for instructors teaching research writing courses for Indigenous students. It is not intended for general composition classes, which are already well supported with a plethora of textbook and resource options. This decision aligns with the need, explicated above, to carefully consider audiences for IK.

Implicitly and explicitly, we began from a desire to be good guests in the Indigenous Peoples' Lands we were in. We cautiously and sometimes hesitantly walked forward in creating this new pathway for writing education and guidance that takes into account current best practices. We seek to provide cultural safety and relevant ways of learning to write that make the most sense to a diversity of Indigenous students from differing backgrounds while respecting and

being in relationship with the local Indigenous Peoples, communities, land, and knowledges where we are doing this work. We found the concept of "Research as Guesthood" as apt and helpful in our basket of concepts, ethics, protocols, and knowledge that helped us in conceptualizing and practicing our approach in our specific context. Research as guesthood (Feltes, 2015; Harvey, 2003), an idea that comes out of Maori community-based scholarship, allows for a positionality that is relational instead of a position that is situated in a polarity of researcher and researched or as miner of knowledge of the researched knowledge holder with connotations of Land and "mine." Research as guesthood allows for an expanded positional space rather than that dichotomy. We see our work as a way of being good guests in Syilx Peoples' land and as a way of reciprocity for the gifts their work in ecosystems' health and in other areas, over millennia and currently, has given and continues to give us.

The project is led by Dr. Kerrie Charnley, a Katzie Coast Salish scholar, whose family comes from the traditional downriver hən̓q̓əmin̓əm̓-speaking Peoples and their Lands and waters of the lower Garibaldi mountain-range, upper Pitt River, down through to the Salish Sea. She has a background in Indigenous communications, literature, and politics of voice, Indigenous language and literacy, writing education, and Indigenous Land and multimodal Arts-based pedagogy. First and second year Syilx students Kalli Van Stone, Meadow Arcand, and Nakoda Parker offered valuable perspectives and created content for the guide. Emily Comeau, a non-Indigenous PhD student in interdisciplinary studies, and fourth year undergraduate English and Cultural Studies major Rachel Pickard provided additional content. In involving students in the creation and writing of the textbook, we used a participatory approach that encouraged not only culturally responsive pedagogy but also student engagement. And finally, Dr. Jordan Stouck, non-Indigenous scholar and previous textbook co-author, offered textbook and composition related advice. In initiating the guide, however, we recognized the need for additional community, both university and Syilx, advice and collaboration.

Following Younging's (2018) principle of drawing on a large circle of perspectives and expertise, we consulted and acknowledged our contributors at all stages. We collaboratively created a Syilx advisory board with Dr. Jeannette Armstrong, Dr. Bill Cohen, Dr. Marlowe Sam, and undergraduate student Meadow Arcand to situate our project in Syilx contexts, knowledges, values, and ways of knowing, stemming from an awareness of mutually reciprocal ethics in regard for and in relationship with Land. We prioritized Syilx practices and methodologies both in the creation and structure of the guide. Given that our guide is being developed on Syilx Peoples' Land, and given UBC's Indigenous Strategic Plan (ISP) and UBCO's Aspire, Learning and Transformation vision, along with UBCO's MOU with the Okanagan Nation Alliance, we felt it was important that the guide be contextualized so that it would contribute to furthering Syilx Peoples' goals regarding education and sovereignty. Locally situating our writing guide was important to us for a number of reasons.

- First, starting with the local mirrors Indigenous Peoples' protocols. Historically and currently in Indigenous communities and intercommunity work, Indigenous conferences, and meetings, it is the local Indigenous Peoples who conduct the proceedings and

leadership of work that happens in their Land. We felt this should also be the case in a writing guide that is for Indigenous students.

- Second, increasing local Indigenous Peoples in the university is a core goal of the UBC Indigenous Strategic Plan.
- Third and importantly, starting with the local is an Indigenizing move, but it is also a decolonizing move. Resurging Indigenous cultures requires upholding and strengthening the identities of local First Nations whose land we are on in our institution, courses, and classrooms.

It means increasing space for Indigenous Peoples' values. Indigenized teaching and learning means engaging in learning activities that not only teach literature, theory, rhetoric, critical analysis, and writing but which concurrently aim to decolonize and Indigenize colonial hegemony in shared spaces. We wondered how an OER could reflect these goals. Renowned Miq'maw scholar Marie Battiste (2022) envisions what she calls "decolonial indigenization" of universities where western European knowledge system's hegemony and dominance recedes so that there are two knowledge systems operating independently and parallel but which come together for specific purposes. Battiste (1995) discusses "cognitive imperialism" as a problem in education and in the structure of universities.

One of Stó:lō scholar Dylan Robinson's (2020) neologisms, "perceptual decolonization," takes this a step further. At the beginning of *Hungry Listening*, Robinson (2020) defines this concept born out of Halqemeylem upriver Coast Salish language as a new pairing of terms that separately refer to White people, shxwelítemelh/xwelítem (hungry starving people, especially during the gold rush), coming into Coast Salish territories at the outset of the colonial period and the word for listening, xwélaĺa:m. Robinson (2020) moves on to claim that there are many ways of listening "guided by positionality as an intersection of perceptual habit, ability, and bias" (p. 37). We tried to be aware of these ways in the way we constructed our OER and appreciated the flexibility an OER offered to change as we progressed in our process.

Robinson argues that one's senses in colonial settler contexts for music, art, education, and other areas are dominated to the exclusion of Indigenous Peoples' multilayered and holistic ways of sensing and the associated logics, values, and purposes with those ways. Ways of governance communicate and are received in the form of regalia, house posts, and other created monuments, in song, music, art, stories and other ways of conveying teachings. Robinson invites us, Indigenous and non-Indigenous readers, to question and expand on what it means to listen but also to question the ways in which we engage with our other senses in what he calls a "multi-layered, palimpsestic sensory engagement" (p. 31).

After discussing different ways to deal with hungry listening, he provides strategies for how his two different audiences can begin to dismantle colonial listening structures. For Indigenous audiences, he explains that "xwélaĺa:m is a form of attention in which we are attentive not just to sound but to the fullest range of sensory experience that connects us to place" (p. 72). We saw an OER as potentially offering space for representation of multisensory engagement through video and similar embeds. One of the visions for our writing guide was that it would provide space to consider decolonizing the scope of sensory experience and in ways that

could reconnect students, their instructors, their learning, and their writing or communicating to place and to Land.

Indeed, in constructing our writing guide we are engaged in a decolonial Indigenization process and make space for a perceptual decolonization that is reflected in the contents of the guide and in its ongoing life into the future. We recognize that Indigenous students navigate cognitive imperialism, hungry listening, and excavation of their knowledge while they are in the academy, in their writing assignments, in classroom discussions and presentations, and in their positions as students. Some students make it clear that they do not speak for Indigenous Peoples. Some students state that they leave it up to their family, community, and elders to decide what epistemic, ontological, cultural, and Traditional Ecological Knowledge to share. Intergenerational family, community and elders share according to their knowledge protocols, ethics, and for a given circumstance, audience, and purpose.

One student on our project protectively and cautiously asked the question, "who are our knowledges for?" They are for us (this "us" being Indigenous Peoples) and to build us up and are the foundation of our resilience. We identified the need for an OER, over other kinds of resources, based on student feedback; accessibility and multimodal components, both of which can be facilitated by OER (Olivier, 2021; Rowsell, 2013), were prominent considerations for students in the focus groups we conducted between March and May 2022. The need to Indigenize academic writing instruction was also seen as an ongoing concern and desired outcome, requiring a format that could be easily revised and updated, like an OER. The focus groups were composed of Indigenous undergraduate and graduate students at UBC Okanagan, and the purpose of these discussions was to engage with Indigenous students and learn about their experiences with university writing. We also sought students' input on what information, resources, supports, and formats would be helpful to include in the writing guide. We asked questions around the process of learning to write, the kinds of instruction and feedback around writing they had received in their classes, and the kinds of support they found helpful in their writing process. We invited participants to discuss their experiences with bringing IK into their coursework and what they thought a cultural way of learning to write might look like.

One common theme in the focus groups concerned the value of connecting with other Indigenous students to share their ideas and inspire each other, and participants explained that these connections helped to energize them in their writing process. Participants also discussed some of the challenges around incorporating IK and cultural teachings into their writing. While most participants said that they carry knowledge and teachings with them in everything they do, they also said that their ability to bring knowledge and teachings into their coursework depended on the course itself and whether IK was valued in that context. They further talked about the importance of protocol and protecting the community when they bring IK and methods into the classroom; they considered what they should be sharing, how to do so respectfully, and how they think their elders would feel about them sharing the knowledge.

Academic writing tends to prioritize research that is considered "peer-reviewed," which in general does not leave room for students to cite Traditional Knowledge or knowledge from elders because cultural teachings and community knowledge are not generally considered

peer-reviewed in the academy. Participants found that when they tried to incorporate knowledge from elders into their writing, it was not always valued. As such, there is a need for increased awareness and education at the university around the value of cultural teachings and an increased understanding that academic peer reviewed articles are not the only valid source of knowledge. This feedback not only suggested the need for OER as a format to address changing needs and expectations, but it also initiated some of the concerns around ownership and sharing principles that we reflect on in this paper.

Students further noted that an Indigenous approach to learning to write should be "holistic" and should include opportunities to learn from elders and other community members in "holistic" environments. Participants recommended the adoption of a pedagogical approach that would include Indigenous storywork and indirect lessons, foster embodied practices of research and writing, and encourage students to consider how they prepare for their work, following Jo-ann Archibald's (2008) principles of Indigenous Storywork and Shawn Wilson's (2008) approach to research as ceremony. They also talked about the potential for transforming the classroom setting by coming together with other students to share their knowledge and collaborate on writing projects, which would create a sense of community with their peers.

In terms of imagining an Indigenized essay process and culturally responsive writing guide, the idea of a spider web or circle model came up in every focus group. In contrast with the linear or hierarchical (e.g., pyramid) models that are often taught in university classes, a spider web model allows a writer to connect a web of ideas to a central concept and to explore how all of these ideas are interwoven or interconnected. In a circle model, progressing through the various steps in writing does not lead to a rigid or final end to the work but rather provides direction for the circle to go around again. An online format like an OER would facilitate this kind of non-linear learning.

When asked if they had any ideas about how the university essay itself might be transformed and Indigenized, participants pointed out that there are many ways to share knowledge and demonstrate understanding. The consensus was that students would appreciate more openness at the university in terms of what research can look like beyond a written essay. There were several suggestions around the inclusion of more creative projects in which students have the freedom to explore topics through media such as podcasts, social media, workshops, presentations, or other kinds of writing (e.g., newspaper articles). The relative ease with which an OER can be continually revised lends itself to supporting new modes and approaches to writing, as well as flexibility in writing instruction.

In terms of accessibility, participants shared a general preference for audiovisual materials over resources that rely exclusively on text—particularly visual infographics that can be shared online and downloaded in PDF format—and a preference for digital over printed resources, which speaks to the benefits that OER can offer. Writing resources formatted like textbooks often take up valuable reading time when students are already managing a significant workload in their classes, whereas audiovisual materials often share information in more immediate ways. Digital resources, and specifically those easily accessible through an OER, can be more manageable than printed resources in terms of file organization, searchability, currency

of information, and linking to additional resources. Cost considerations were important to students with limited budgets, also making an OER preferrable. Most participants shared that they would find video tutorials helpful on topics such as writing techniques, citations, formatting, and developing ideas, and suggested the inclusion of PDF summaries as well, which users could then return to as needed. It would also be helpful to include examples of writing and templates for different kinds of papers in the guide (e.g., showing the key differences between a conventional academic writing process and a land-based writing process).

Ultimately, participants stressed that it would be helpful to include a variety of formats in order to support different learning preferences and recommended the inclusion of interactive elements in order to make the guide engaging to learners. When asked specifically about hosting the guide, participants requested either a website that is visible to search engines; hosting the guide on Canvas or a similar learning platform with easily navigable sections; or hosting the guide as an OER so that Indigenous students and community members who are not affiliated with UBC Okanagan can also access it. Some participants mentioned that they would find it helpful to learn about teachings from other Indigenous cultures and nations, a kind of exchange easily enabled by an OER. In order to respect and honour teachings, however, participants noted it was important to always credit knowledge that is shared and to be mindful of the protocols around sharing knowledge in the writing guide, particularly on an open platform. These concerns raised in the focus groups contributed to our thinking in this article on ownership in an OER context and the need to implement principles of caring, sharing, protection, and responsibility.

We found from listening to the Indigenous students in the focus groups that writing Indigenously includes not only style but also "Indigenized" processes involved in communicating and writing, Indigenous Peoples' epistemological, ontological, and pedagogical models (i.e., circle, spiral, spider web), and multimodal formats of communicating (visual, audio, oral, material) that follow the oral tradition. A fourth-year student who we video interviewed in September 2022 raised an interesting question. When asked if he had any experiences of Indigenized academic writing in his courses or if he had any suggestions for how he would like to see academic writing genres such as the essay be Indigenized, his response was, "I have trouble envisioning what an Indigenized essay would look like. The university seems intent on Indigenizing content within what are essentially colonial structures, but underneath they are still colonial structures" (Charnley et al., 2022).

This response raised several questions. Can, and should an academic essay be Indigenized? What alternative forms of learning assessment could arise out of Indigenous Peoples' structures with which students could engage to show their learning instead of the essay or that could be created alongside the essay? Can an OER facilitate these shifts? Students could create oral narratives or histories for example, and in oral narratives or in writing they could bring in testimony from their family and community members. Students could be permitted to create other forms of mixed or multimodal materials and artifacts to produce and show their learning in a given course.

We note that such student requests for culturally appropriate and linguistically responsive curricula are aligned with recent calls for linguistic justice arising out of Writing Across the

Curriculum and composition studies. In 2020 and 2021, the influential Conference on College Composition and Communication (the 4Cs) published several policy statements on social and linguistic justice in writing studies. These calls urge greater recognition and redress for cultural and historical biases within writing assessment, pedagogy, and curricular contexts. As the 4C statement on White Language Supremacy affirms, "we must be attuned to the workings of linguistic imperialism and...oppressive [educational] practices...must be interrogated and challenged" (2021).

Linguistic justice in Canada is still in its nascent stages, but our approaches to "Red" or "Rez" English and Indigenous students' vernacular in the guide and advice for instructors around culturally appropriate or sensitive assessment practices draw connections to the work of activist scholars such as Asao Inoue (2015), April Baker-Bell (2020), and Vershawn Ashanti Young (2020). As these authors explain, the valuing of some language forms over others and the ongoing replication of that within educational practices, must change. Our guide thus seeks to revalue and prioritize Indigenous writing styles, ontologies, methodologies, and forms of expression and encourages Indigenous students to write in the language(s) and structures or methods meaningful to them as steps towards this change.

In summary, student interviews and input through the creation of the guide pointed to the need for an accessible and multimodal approach facilitated through an OER. Indeed, the multimodal format made sense as a way to incorporate oral documents. The OER format also allows the resource to exist as a living document in this time when practices around Indigenous resources are changing rapidly. Western scholarly and academic institutions and practices often continue to privilege written papers and essays over creative, visual, and audio modes of communicating information and knowledge. While the development and prioritized use of formal writing styles and "firmly established protocols and practices" within universities and other academic institutions may provide a useful standard of communicating information across disciplines, it also constitutes and restricts what counts as valid scholarship (Chapman and Sawchuk 2012, p. 6).

By upholding and imposing strict metrics of measuring and evaluating academic research, new barriers and methods to maintain and enforce the standardized modes of communication are put into place, and other methods of communication are delegitimized and dismissed. Oftentimes, these standards exclude "creative" projects using "video, performance, film, sound work, blog, or multimedia text" (Chapman and Sawchuk, 2012, p. 6). Consequently, many essential ways of communicating ideas and information have not been seen as contributions to scholarship, and vital voices and knowledge have been neglected. However, this is changing, and scholars are beginning to recognize other, more creative methods of communication, especially as they can often reveal and build knowledge and understanding in ways written text cannot.

Audio recordings, oral histories, and storytelling practices all employ sound to create, maintain, and affirm meaning over time and space. Recordings of sound, for example, take advantage of their "real-time quality" to put listeners "into time that has already passed and opens a tunnel connection with the past" (Camlot, 2019, p. 3). Oral histories and storytelling

work in a similar way, even when they are given in the present. Speakers share histories and stories of the past that are carried in memory to constantly transcend time and space, often from generation to generation. Syilx captik^{w}ɬ, for instance, is described by Dr. Jeannette Armstrong (2009) as being "characterised by features of language and structure that serve to move the listener between the past, present and future time as well as universal time" (p. 95). Storytelling practices often carry unique bodies of knowledge and information held in many individual Indigenous Nations transmitted orally over centuries, each with their own distinct cultural content (Younging 2018, p. 12).

As Gregory Cajete (2000) affirms, Indigenous stories and storytelling practices inherently "chart the development of human beings in relationship to the places in which they have lived" (p. 13). Carrying the stories into the present and future thus maintain and sustain the historical legacies, culture, and knowledge and reaffirm them as constant and everlasting. This also creates the possibility for new stories. Our process in creating the guide thus led us to prioritize access, consultation, and reciprocity; to value the local; to explore perceptual decolonization through designing the guide as a living and multimodal OER; and to indigenize the interstitial space of the academy, rethinking concepts such as ownership, levels of access, citation, and the models we use to teach and learn.

Indigenous Storywork, Indigenous Knowledges, and OER

In approaching OER and IK, we found it helpful to consult with the seven principles of Indigenous storywork (Archibald, 2008): respect, relationship, reciprocity, reverence, synergy, wholism, and interrelatedness. We also consulted David Wiley's (2014) work on the 5Rs of *openness* (retention, reuse, revise, remix, and redistribute) to find that many of those principles needed to be held in tension with principles of Indigenous storywork. One could say that since the onset of colonialism, IK has been retained, revised, remixed, reused, and redistributed without consent. The 5Rs of OER therefore are of concern to us since they seem at first glance to mirror the colonial moves that have caused harm.

We recognize that we are not the first researchers to raise these concerns and hold these ideas in tension; we appreciate the principles set out by McCracken and Hogan (2020) and Kayla Lar-Son (2021). As explained below, our guide applies the principles in a specific context, a process which raised additional questions and concerns that needed to be thought through. In recounting our process, we hope that others can benefit from our experience and that this case study will assist future producers of educational resources in thinking through these issues and holding in tension the ideals of OER with principles of IK sharing. We also realize that, while examples can be helpful, readers will need to consider these ideas and apply them in their own contexts.

The following paragraphs present our thinking on how OER can better integrate Indigenous research principles and the decisions we made in creating our guide. In her work, *A Digital Bundle*, Jennifer Wemigwans (2018) distinguishes sacred from personal knowledge, discussing the need to carefully consider what is shared in digital contexts. In developing an OER, Wemigwans (2018) cautions became intertwined with our production of the resource.

What should be shared and in what ways? How do notions of preserving and protecting certain knowledges for certain audiences relate to principles of OER? While it was clearly important to provide culturally appropriate or responsive information to our student audience, how could we do so in a way that respected the knowledges we were conveying?

In *Elements of Indigenous Style*, Greg Younging (2018) reminds us that just because an IK is found in the common public realm does not mean it is appropriate to "use," or "take" that knowledge because historically and currently IK has been stolen, extracted, and turned into a resource, re and de-contextualized, misused, published, distributed, displayed, collected, and archived, without consent. We are not completely comfortable with the term "resource" when discussing IK, as for Indigenous Peoples' their IK is not a resource in the sense of the word's connotation of extracting a resource and extractive mining. We are cognizant of this term in the name "open educational resource." We question how else might we think of knowledge.

One could say that IK has been retained, revised, remixed, reused, redistributed without consent. This is widely of concern amongst Indigenous communities, leadership, and scholarship (Assembly of First Nations, 2011; Blomfield et al., 2002; Charnley, 1990; Kahnesatake Schools Diabetes Prevention Project, 2007; Schnarch, 2004; Younging, 2018). In the 1990s, the Kahnesatake Diabetes Project created an ethics protocol to protect their IK. The Ownership, Control, Access and Protection (OCAP) policy was developed in the community, activated in the First Nations and Inuit Regional Health Survey conducted in the late 1990s, and became available during this same era (Schnarch, 2004). It became clear in developing our guide that Western concepts of owning knowledge needed to be replaced with ideas of holding or keeping knowledge in the community.

In contrast with the first R of *openness*: retention, (Wiley, 2014), in *Elements of Indigenous Style*, Greg Younging (2018) describes the European origins of copyright and uses case studies to note how copyright laws have not served IK or communities well. The notion of retaining control and "ownership" as a principle of OER for an Indigenous resource therefore needs to be understood with recognition of the assumptions behind this idea; in Indigenous OER contexts these rights must extend to oral content and practices not typically recognized by copyright. Similarly, such rights may not lie with an individual, as is the assumption in copyright law, but with a community or a family within a community. Younging (2018) further notes that knowledge is not necessarily treated as a commodity in Indigenous communities, placing many of the principles behind the idea of "making, owning and retaining control" at odds with the content of our guide.

Archibald (2008), included in the seven principles of Indigenous storywork, and Kirkness and Barnhardt (2001), included in their 4Rs, emphasize the principle of responsibility that lies with individuals to family, community, elders, Land, and ancestors, along with the principles of reciprocity, respect, and relevance (Kirkness and Barnhardt, 1991; 2001) and with the additional Indigenous storywork principles of reverence, synergy, wholism, and interrelatedness (Archibald, 2010). We also very much have appreciated the work of Kayla Lar-Son in this area and notice Kayla Lar-Son's 6Rs of Indigenous OER (respect, responsibility, relevance, reverence,

reciprocity, and relationships) are also drawn from the 4Rs and from the UBC Longhouse Teachings.

The UBC Longhouse Teachings were drawn from four of the seven principles of Indigenous storywork with the exception of synergy, wholism, and interrelatedness. Similarly, Robinson (2020) emphasizes positionality and ethics in regard to IK in the public stages and domains. So, on the one hand, ownership as a concept must be revised, yet it should not be abandoned within OER. Rather than the Western capital colonial concept of ownership—a term that might best be composted in this context—instead Indigenous Peoples' principles of responsibility, accountability, and care ought to be foregrounded. That said, McCracken and Hogan (2020) note the need for ownership as a way to prevent appropriation and recommend the use of TK labels in OER resources. Given the history of appropriation of IK, it is vital that the origins of TK be recognized and retained by the communities and families that the TK and IK come from and who essentially hold these knowledges.

In one approach to revising understandings of ownership, we therefore developed and will continue to develop our guide as a living document, one that will change and be added to by multiple groups. Similarly, our process in developing the guide, including student input, guided by the advisory, and written by multiple contributors (from various perspectives) challenges traditional notions of copyright. To include oral and non-traditional formats, the guide is multimodal. We also carefully considered citation practices both as a component of the guide and as a practice, citing ethics for oral and land-based knowledges. We discussed the practice of oral citation that occurs in Indigenous communities "on the daily" and connected those practices to the land acknowledgements that have arisen in the past decades, most notably since the Truth and Reconciliation Commission and TRC Report, *Response, Responsibility and Renewal: The Journey toward Truth and Reconciliation* (Younging et al., 2009).

The land acknowledgements are a kind of citation. We argue that land acknowledgements are not just check box reconciliation moves, but more importantly land acknowledgements cite the Indigenous People or Nation and the land that supports the work, health and well-being of everyone who is in that place where the acknowledgement is occurring. Such acknowledgement through citation is a component of accountability and responsibility and something that has been neglected in colonial contexts. We noticed there was a gap in published work regarding citation in IK contexts. We looked to and appreciated Lorisia MacLeod's (2022) work with Norquest College in Edmonton. Recognizing the lack of a citation format in most academic styles in terms of oral narrative and the wisdom of elders and knowledge keepers (and hence lack of recognition or attribution), MacLeod (2022) has developed a format that includes a locally specific Cree concept, "in the spirit of wahkôhtowin and reconciliation". This is both an area of ongoing work, pointing to the need for OER as a living document, as well as recognition of the gaps in existing practices. In these ways, the guide changes notions of ownership with considerations around respecting the origins and complexity of IK as well as around reciprocity as a different way to view these interactions with IK in open education.

Another related area we considered carefully was the audience for the guide and how notions of audience relate to OER principles. In xwélmexw Stó:lō scholar Dylan Robinson's

(2020) uptake of the question regarding who IK are for, he speaks to and enacts a *boundary that* simultaneously takes action Indigenizing and decolonizing the structure of academic writing and audience expectation. Robinson takes control of the knowledge he is sharing when he directly asks non-Indigenous readers to stop reading a certain section of one of his first chapters, declaring that it is only for Indigenous readers. At the end of the section, he asks if any of the non-Indigenous readers read that section despite his request and if so, he asks them why they did in spite of his request not to. This serves to make the reader uncomfortably self-conscious and question their ethical relation to the author. In this directive to his audience or reader, Robinson (2020) creates a space where the reader is faced with an ethical dilemma in their reading practice.

His writing could be said to be activism enacted through writing, an in-text action, an activist writing, a decolonial Indigenization and restructuring of expectations in academic writing (Kirkness and Barnhardt, 1991; 2001). An Indigenized structure is woven with Indigenous structures such as upriver Coast Salish halq'eméylem language, words, terms, concepts and halq'eméylem neologisms such as "shxwelítemelh [xwelítem] xwélaĺa:m" (white/hungry people + listening = white peoples' kind of listening). Robinson's (2020) work complements actions the Stó:lō nation are taking to protect their differing kinds of Knowledges in the public domain.

The nation has considered ways to address differing audiences, purposes for sharing their knowledge and created layers of protected access for differing audiences within their website. One of the Stó:lō nations has similarly put password protection on their site for differing levels of access to their IK. In 2002, the Stó:lō Nation's commissioned report on protecting their knowledge contained a definition of Stó:lō Knowledge (Blomfield et al., 2002). The protective areas described do not refer to knowledge in the online milieu. In 2022, Sqewlets began utilizing TK Labels to help audiences navigate the differing kinds of knowledges on the website. There are four TK Labels that apply to the entire website, but there are other TK Labels that refer to knowledges, such as "xa:xa," ("Secret/Sacred Knowledge") (Halq'eméylem upriver Coast Salish language) that are not shared or accessible to everyone on the website (Sq'éwlets, 2016). The TK Labels come from the Local Contexts Grounding Indigenous Rights project (Local Contexts, 2022).

In an OER, the ability to control the audience, who reads and how they use the information, can be minimal. OER principles like "reuse: the right to use the content in a wide range of ways (e.g., in a class, in a study group, on a website, in a video") and "redistribute: the right to share copies of the original content, your revisions, or your remixes with others" (e.g., give a copy of the content to a friend) needed to be rethought in relation to IK (Wiley 2014). Therefore, we realized that in our guide we have to be clear in terms of who our intended audience is and the purpose of the textbook. Similarly, we have to consider carefully what kinds of knowledges are included in the text. We have a responsibility to write with community and family protocols in mind and to not share knowledge that is private or sacred and communally or family "owned" or "held."

The 4Rs and the Indigenous storywork principles of responsibility, relevance, and respect are shown and enacted through accountability to the knowledge, people, land, and ancestors.

Accountability can be enacted by learning and adhering to a given community's protocols regarding their knowledges. In terms of remix, the right to combine the original or revised content with other open content to create something new (e.g., incorporate the content into a mashup), given the history of settler appropriation of Indigenous culture, land and the recent increases in the theft of Indigenous identity, the OER principle of "remixing" must be approached or engaged in very cautiously, if at all (unless one is educated in the nuances of the knowledge and its associated protocols in the community or family). We found the CARE principles (collective benefit, authority to control, responsibility, and ethics) for Indigenous data governance helpful for thinking through the tension between Wiley's 5Rs, Kirkness and Barnhardt's 4Rs, and Archibald's 7 principles that together amount to 8 principles (three overlapping and four additional in the seven principles of Indigenous storywork), for engaging with IK in education, research, and storytelling.

Indigenous Storywork principles of interrelatedness, synergy, and holism are as yet less discussed principles that we believe deserve further thought and consideration in the OER realm, and we pursue these conversations as we finish our guide. We see these principles as offering potential ways for the two knowledge systems, represented by Wiley's 5Rs, Archibald, Barnhardt and Kirkness's eight principles, and GIDA's FAIR and CARE principles (Carroll et al., 2022), to be in conversation with each other in ways that hopefully will lead to mutually reciprocal synergies, interrelatedness, and an inclusive holism in which diversity and multimodal communication of knowledge in academia can occur. Finally, at all stages of our project we sought to follow Indigenous methodologies and processes, applying the knowledges we were describing to our own writing and decision making during the guide's creation.

Conclusion

In conclusion, we leave our readers with the following questions: What might responsibility and accountability and care look like for an Indigenous person wishing to work with IK and IKK in an OER milieu? What might responsibility and accountability and care look like for a settler or non-Indigenous person wishing to work with IK and IKK? Should a settler work with IK, or should a settler instead work with an IKK who holds the IK? What might responsibility and accountability look like for a settler or non-Indigenous person wishing to work with IK and IKK in an OER milieu? Examples of the interplay between OER principles and IK principles are newly emerging.

Our process in developing the writing guide and reflection on that process here reveal that ownership must be carefully negotiated in an IK and OER context; given colonial practices, ownership can neither be abandoned nor assumed unproblematically. Similarly, OER principles of remixing, reusing, and revising must be balanced with the IK principles of respect, reciprocity, accountability, and care. We found that the multimodal, communal, and versatile aspects of OER offer opportunities to work in ways that, while not free from the hazards of replicating colonial attitudes, nevertheless enable new kinds of work and discussion to take place. We hope the preceding of our process and the questions and approaches generated through that process are helpful to developers of other Indigenous-focused OER resources. hay čxʷ q̓ə o'siem.

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